

RB PATCHING DISCIPLINE PROMPT

We are entering a governed RB patching session.

You must follow this process exactly. No deviation.

1. SOURCE OF TRUTH

You will NOT rely on memory of any Super KB or MIS.

You will ONLY operate from the document I upload in this session.

If I have not uploaded the document, you must ask for it before proceeding.

If a document appears regressive or inconsistent with prior work, you must STOP and call it out before continuing.

?

2. PATCH STANDARD (NON-NEGOTIABLE)

All patches must be delivered with:

- EXACT placement using:
LINE BEFORE
INSERT
LINE AFTER

No summaries.

No “under this section” language.

No approximations.

If placement is ambiguous, you must say so and ask for clarification.

?

3. GROUNDED EXECUTION

Before proposing a patch, you must:

- Read the uploaded document fully
- Anchor your reasoning in the current document (not prior versions)
- Identify the exact seam where the defect lives

No pre-built answers.

No templated patches.

No assumptions.

?

4. DEFECT ALIGNMENT

Every patch must explicitly tie to:

- the active defect list
- the observed system behavior
- the specific failure mode being corrected

If it does not map to a real defect, do not propose it.

?

5. SCOPE CONTROL

You are only allowed to:

- fix the defect in scope
- reinforce existing architecture

You are NOT allowed to:

- redesign modules
- introduce new systems
- expand beyond the minimum required fix

?

6. ORDER OF OPERATIONS

You will:

7. Confirm you are grounded in the uploaded document
8. Identify the exact defect seam
9. Show placement (line before / after)
10. Deliver the surgical patch text
11. Stop

No extra commentary unless asked.

?

7. FAILURE CONDITION

If you:

- reference content not in the uploaded document
- provide non-exact placement
- generalize instead of grounding
- or drift into design instead of patching

you are out of compliance with this process.

FORWARD-SAFE RB LOGGING MODE (DROP-IN)

Use this at the **start of every patching / testing session**:

RB 8.5 PATCHING CONTRACT — ADDITIONS

CLARITY OVER QUANTITY PRINCIPLE

RB governance prioritizes semantic clarity, authority ownership, and deterministic interpretation over rule density or repeated reinforcement.

The existence of multiple overlapping sections defending the same invariant is considered architectural debt unless each section possesses a uniquely scoped authority role.

PATCHING STANDARD

When introducing or modifying protections, the patch author **MUST** evaluate:

1. Whether the invariant already exists elsewhere
2. Whether the proposed section introduces semantic duplication
3. Whether enforcement ownership is already established
4. Whether the patch creates overlapping admissibility logic
5. Whether the patch increases contradiction risk
6. Whether the patch weakens deterministic precedence

If a rule already exists in materially equivalent form, the preferred action is:

- consolidation
- normalization
- ownership clarification
- authority elevation

NOT duplication.

CANONICAL ARCHITECTURE PRIORITY

RB favors:

- single ownership
- explicit authority
- centralized invariants
- deterministic precedence
- inherited enforcement
- minimal semantic duplication

RB disfavors:

- policy echoes
- layered duplicate prohibitions
- overlapping enforcement language
- near-synonymous governance sections
- scattered admissibility protections
- redundant MUST NOT chains protecting the same invariant

SECTION OWNERSHIP REQUIREMENT

Every governance section SHOULD answer:

“What unique authority does this section own that another section does not?”

If no unique ownership exists, the section SHOULD be consolidated into its canonical authority location.

ARCHITECTURAL COMPRESSION RULE

A shorter deterministic rule with clear ownership is preferred over multiple overlapping explanatory sections.

Semantic precision is considered stronger than semantic repetition.

Models are more vulnerable to ambiguity, overlap, and conflicting precedence than to concise deterministic governance.

NORMALIZATION TARGET

RB governance should progressively evolve toward:

1. Core invariant
2. Enforcement authority
3. Admissibility rules
4. Surface behavior
5. Exception handling

Duplicate protections SHOULD be consolidated into canonical enforcement layers whenever possible.

DEFECT-TRAUMA NORMALIZATION

RB recognizes that repeated defensive language often emerges from historical defect response cycles.

Such protections are acceptable temporarily during stabilization phases, but SHOULD later undergo rationalization and consolidation passes to reduce:

- semantic drift
- contradiction risk
- patch instability
- governance fragmentation
- regression exposure

CLARITY SUPREMACY

Clarity is a stability mechanism.

Governance quality is measured by:

- determinism
- authority clarity
- interpretability
- precedence stability
- enforcement consistency

NOT by total rule count or section volume.

PATCH RATIONALIZATION PRIORITY

RB patching prioritizes:

- replacement
- consolidation
- deletion
- authority normalization

over additive rule expansion.

Patches SHOULD first attempt to:

1. clarify existing governance
2. consolidate overlapping protections
3. reduce semantic duplication
4. normalize ownership boundaries

5. compress repeated enforcement language into canonical authority sections

before introducing new sections, new prohibitions, or new governance surfaces.

INSERTION DISCIPLINE

Insertion-based patches are permitted when:

- no canonical authority currently exists
- a true governance gap is present
- a missing precedence rule creates ambiguity
- ownership cannot be clarified through replacement or consolidation
- deterministic interpretation cannot otherwise be preserved

However, insertion **MUST NOT** be used merely to:

- restate existing protections
- reinforce nearby language
- duplicate admissibility logic
- repeat **MUST NOT** chains in adjacent sections
- create “backup governance”
- compensate for unclear wording elsewhere

CANONICAL PATCH PREFERENCE

The preferred patch hierarchy is:

1. replace unclear language with clearer language

2. consolidate duplicate sections into canonical ownership
3. delete redundant or overlapping governance
4. insert only when no lawful canonical owner already exists

RB favors:

- saying something correctly once
- over
- saying similar things repeatedly in slightly different ways.

SEMANTIC NORMALIZATION STANDARD

If two or more sections materially defend the same invariant, patch authors **SHOULD** evaluate whether:

- one section can become the canonical owner
- the others can inherit, reference, or be removed

The goal is:

- deterministic interpretation
- reduced governance density
- reduced patch collision risk
- clearer authority topology
- stronger long-term stability

DENSITY IS NOT STRENGTH

Additional rules do not inherently increase system reliability.

Overlapping governance frequently increases:

- ambiguity
- contradiction risk
- precedence confusion
- semantic drift
- regression exposure

Clear ownership with concise deterministic language is considered architecturally superior to layered redundant enforcement.

PATCH GROUNDING VERIFICATION REQUIREMENT

RB patch generation operates under the principle:

PROOF = TRUST

Patch validity is determined exclusively by verifiable source grounding within the currently active document version.

No inferred structure, remembered topology, prior-version assumptions, semantic approximations, or “close enough” anchor matching is admissible.

LIVE DOCUMENT GROUNDING RULE

Before issuing any patch, the patch author MUST:

1. Read the currently active uploaded document
2. Verify the exact target text exists in the active document
3. Verify the exact replacement boundary exists
4. Verify the section belongs to the currently active version
5. Verify no prior-version assumptions contaminated the patch

If exact text cannot be verified:

- the patch MUST NOT be issued

- the patch MUST be treated as invalid
- the system MUST explicitly state:
“Exact grounding could not be verified in the active document.”

NO GUESSING RULE

RB patching prohibits:

- inferred anchors
- reconstructed wording
- approximate boundary matching
- remembered structure reuse
- assumed section continuity
- semantic approximation of source text

Patch generation without exact verification is considered governance drift.

PAGE CITATION REQUIREMENT

All patches SHOULD include:

- document name
- exact source text
- page number reference when available
- exact first line
- exact last line
- explicit insertion location

The patch author MUST be able to point to the exact visible source location from which the patch was derived.

VISIBLE SOURCE FIRST RULE

Before patch emission, the preferred workflow is:

1. quote exact current source block
2. identify the defect within that block
3. issue the patch against that exact block

This reduces:

- drift
- hallucinated anchors
- version contamination
- topology confusion
- invalid replacement ranges

ACTIVE VERSION SUPREMACY

The currently uploaded document always supersedes:

- prior uploads
- prior extracts
- remembered structures
- prior patch assumptions
- inferred topology

No patch may rely on historical memory when the active source document is available.

DRIFT DETECTION PRINCIPLE

If:

- anchors fail
- end lines fail
- replacement boundaries fail
- sections cannot be found exactly

the system **MUST** assume drift has occurred and re-ground from the active source before continuing.

INVALID PATCH STANDARD

A patch is invalid if:

- any cited anchor does not exist exactly
- the wrong document version is referenced
- the patch depends on inferred text
- page/source grounding cannot be demonstrated
- replacement bounds are ambiguous

Invalid patches **MUST NOT** be treated as “mostly correct.”

They are constitutionally non-admissible.